

consoles were not easily available in the market. But after growth of the electronics industry, gradually video games became very popular all over the world.

Many such companies as Atari, Nintendo and Sega started selling game consoles in the market during the 1980s. Later, companies like Sony also introduced many gaming consoles like PlayStation and captured the market in late 1990s. After emergence of PC gaming, people started playing video games on their PCs and laptops, either at home or work. Now people like playing video games on their cell-phones, too.

Video game addiction and de-addiction

According to American Psychiatric Association, video games cannot cause any kind of addiction. But these can cause a different kind of addiction—a kind of behavioural addiction that makes someone play video games excessively, and that interferes with everyday life. There is no approved



Gaming console (Credit: <https://s12emagst.akamaized.net>)

medication for this type of addiction, but still most psychiatrists are treating video game addiction using psychiatric drugs.

Behavioural addiction is a kind of addiction that does not involve use of any drugs. This type of addiction happens because of the rewarding system of our brain. Our brain is functioning because of neurotransmitters like serotonin, GABA and dopamine. Certain activity or behaviour of a person can increase such neurotransmitter levels

in the brain and give pleasure. That is why this could vary from person to person, because everybody's brain chemistry is different. Some people might find video games addictive, while some might find them a waste of time.

Usually, any drug-related addiction is cured using de-addiction (substitute) drugs. In case of a drug addiction, the brain gets dependent on a particular drug, and to de-addict someone from that drug, a substitute drug is used with a tapering plan. As the substitute drug is tapered gradually on daily basis, the brain starts to reduce its dependency on the addicted drug.

Similarly, for any behavioural addiction like video gaming, de-addiction can be done using a substitute game. For example, when a user starts playing a game, he or she may find some difficulty in the beginning, but after winning the first level of the game, dopamine levels increase and he or she may want to play the next level. As the level goes up, difficulty

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